

Custodian of Heritage

For Good Earth Founder Anita Lal, the recipe for success is to do what you are passionate about and feel happy about it

BY NAVNEET DUBEY



ANITA LAL HAS transformed Indian pottery and design with a vision that bridged the country's traditional crafts with modern aesthetics. "As a studio potter back in the day, I saw a market gap between the dying art of India's village potters and the urban consumer looking for high-quality home products. We began our journey with a mission to bring our crafts into the contemporary [discourse]," says the Founder of Good Earth.

This way, she spotted an opportunity to revive India's artistic heritage by creating high-quality home products for urban consumers. In 1996, with no business

background and a degree in psychology, she launched Good Earth, driven by a mission to bring India's village crafts into contemporary relevance.

In an era when organised retail in India was virtually nonexistent, Lal had to navigate various challenges to build the brand. But her perseverance and passion paid off and she was able to establish Good Earth as a pioneering luxury brand celebrating Indian craftsmanship. The brand recently expanded its footprint with a boutique in Lucknow, a store designed in collaboration with Interior Designer Adil Ahmad, drawing inspiration from the city's iconic



ANITA LAL

76, Founder & Creative Director, Good Earth

WHY SHE MATTERS

Her dedication towards her craft has not only redefined Indian luxury retail but also inspired a new generation of artisans and designers to embrace and elevate traditional crafts

Awadhi architecture.

"You've got to be passionate. If you truly want to do something. If it truly makes you happy, then you will find a way to make it succeed," says Lal. For her, success stems from passion, pure intent, and a committed team. She believes that a strong foundation rests on shared vision and values among team members.

Her guiding principles reflect a dedication to authenticity and resilience, a philosophy that has stayed with her from the time she was young: stay true to your vision, nurture relationships, and balance ambition with self-care. Lal's story is a testament to the power of purpose-driven entrepreneurship, illustrating how love for craft and culture can create a brand that resonates across generations. **BT**

@imNavneetDubey